

KATHRYN E. SCHERTZ

Curriculum Vitae

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[OSF](#) | [Google scholar](#) | [Research Gate](#) | [Personal website](#)

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Aug 2022-Present Postdoctoral Research Fellow

University of Michigan, Department of Psychology
Emotion & Self Control Lab, Director: Ethan Kross, PhD

Feb 2024-Present Postdoctoral Research Fellow

Michigan State University, Department of Psychology
Clinical Psychophysiology Lab, Director: Jason Moser, PhD

EDUCATION

Jun 2022 University of Chicago

Ph.D., Psychology (Integrative Neuroscience concentration)
Certificate in Urban Science & Sustainable Development
Mentor: Marc Berman, PhD

Jun 2019 University of Chicago

M.A., Psychology

May 2008 University of Pennsylvania

B.A., Cognitive Science (Cognitive Neuroscience concentration)
Magna cum laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I leverage social, cognitive, and clinical psychology frameworks to examine how the complex interplay between affective & cognitive processing, individual differences, and the physical environment influences wellbeing and mental health. Primarily using experimental and experience sampling methodologies, I take a naturalistic approach that examines people within their real-world environments. Much of my work focuses on aspects of self-referential processing and how it can be modulated to improve regulatory outcomes in clinical and non-clinical populations.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

2008–2014 Surface Warfare Officer, U.S. Navy
Norfolk, VA / Pearl Harbor, HI

GRANTS & AWARDS

2024	UROP Research Grant, University of Michigan (\$1,000)
2018	Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation (\$138,000)
2018	App Challenge First Place, University of Chicago (\$7,000)

PUBLICATIONS

Patents

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., Berman, M.G., & Kompare, T.N. (2019). Routing in Navigation Applications based on Restorative Score. *U.S. Patent Accepted No. 16/418,522*. Washington, DC: U.S. Patent and Trademark Office.

Journal Articles and Chapters

* Indicates authors contributed equally

[26] Schertz, K.E.*, Meidenbauer, K.L.*, Freeman, T.R., Santiago, I.M., Janey, E.A., Gehrke, K., Samtani, A.L., Stier, A.J., & Berman, M.G. (2025). Identifying qualities and amenities associated with perceived cognitive restoration and improved affect in urban parks. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 104, 102624.

[25] Trinh, E.N.*, **Schertz, K.E.***, & Kross, E. (2025). Do you have a minute? The cognitive & emotional consequences of self-disclosure at work. *Emotion*. Advance online publication: <https://dx.doi.org/10.1037/emo0001539>

Trinh, E.N. & Schertz, K.E. (August 20, 2025). Should you share personal stuff at work? Invited submission for "Character and Context" blog for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.

[24] Rim, N.*, **Schertz, K.E.***, & Berman, M.G. (2025). The affective, cognitive, and social benefits of interacting with nature. *Journal of Consumer Psychology*, 35(3), 495-510.

[23] Baldwin, C.R.*, **Schertz, K.E.***, Orvell, A.*, Costello, C., Takahashi, S., Moser, J.S., Ayduk, O., & Kross, E. (2025). Managing emotions in everyday life: Why a toolbox of strategies matters. *Emotion*, 25(5), 1122-1136.

[22] Rodriguez, M., **Schertz, K.E.**, & Kross, E. (2025). How people think about being alone shapes their experience of loneliness. *Nature Communications*, 16(1), 1594.

[21] Meidenbauer, K.L., **Schertz, K.E.**, Janey, E.A., Stier, A.J., Samtani, A.L., Gehrke, K., Tucker, R., Hasan, M., & Berman, M.G. (2025) Evidence for environmental influences on impulsivity and aggression. *Urban Forestry & Urban Greening*, 103, 128594.

- [20] Meidenbauer, K.L., **Schertz, K.E.**, Li, P., Sharma, A., Freeman, T.R., Janey, E.A., Stier, A.J., Samtani, A.L., Gehrke, K., & Berman, M.G. (2024). Variable and dynamic associations between hot weather, thermal comfort, and individuals' emotional states during summertime. *BMC Psychology*, 12, 504.
- [19] Akcelik, G.N., Choe, K.W., Rosenberg, M.D., **Schertz, K.E.**, Meidenbauer, K.L., Zhang, T., Rim, N. Tucker, R., Talen, E., & Berman, M.G. (2024). Quantifying urban environments: Aesthetic preference through the lens of prospect-refuge theory. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 97, 102344.
- [18] Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Schachner, J.N., Ip, K.I, **Schertz, K.E.**, Gonzalez, M.R., Abad, S., Herting, M.M. (2024). Building towards an adolescent neural urbanome: Expanding environmental measures using linked external data (LED) in the ABCD Study. *Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience*, 65, 101338.
- [17] **Schertz, K.E.**, Kotabe, H.P., Meidenbauer, K.L., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Bowman, J.E., ... & Berman, M.G. (2023). Nature's path to thinking about others and the surrounding environment. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 89, 102046.
- Schertz, K.E. (September 25, 2023). Thinking too much about yourself? Nature could help with that. Invited submission for "Character and Context" blog for the Society for Personality and Social Psychology.
- [16] **Schertz, K.E.**, Bowman, J.E., Kotabe, H.P., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Lakhtakia, T., Lyu, M., Paraschos, O., Van Hedger, S.C., Vohs, K.D., & Berman, M.G. (2022). Environmental influences on affect and cognition: A study of natural and commercial semi-public spaces. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 83, 101852.
- [15] Kardan, O., Stier, A.J., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., **Schertz, K.E.**, Pruin, J.C., Deng, Y.,... & Rosenberg, M.D. (2022). Differences in the functional brain architecture of sustained attention and working memory in youth and adults. *PLoS Biology*, 20(12), e3001938.
- [14] Akcelik, G.N., **Schertz, K.E.**, & Berman, M.G. (2022). The influence of low- and mid-level visual features on the perception of streetscape qualities. In B. Ionescu & W. Bainbridge, *Human perceptions of visual information: Psychological and computational perspectives*. Springer.
- [13] **Schertz, K.E.**, Saxon, J., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Bettencourt, L.M.A., Ding, Y., Hoffmann, H., & Berman, M.G. (2021). Neighborhood street activity and greenspace usage uniquely contribute to predicting crime. *npj Urban Sustainability*, 1, 19.
- [12] Stier, A.J., **Schertz, K.E.**, Rim, N.W., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Lahey, B.B., Bettencourt, L.M.A., & Berman, M.G. (2021). Evidence and theory for lower rates of depression in larger US urban areas. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 118(31), e2022472118.
- [11] Berman, M.G., Stenfors, C.U.D., **Schertz, K.E.**, & Meidenbauer, K.L. (2021). Response to "Conceptual replication study and meta-analysis suggest simulated nature does not reliably

restore pure executive attention measured by the Attention Network Task." *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 78, 101719.

[10] **Schertz, K.E.***, Meidenbauer, K.L.*, & Berman, M.G. (2021). Understanding the affective benefits of interacting with nature. In E. Brymer, M. Rogerson, & J. Barton, *Nature and Health: Physical activity in nature*. Rutledge.

[9] **Schertz, K.E.**, Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2020). Visual features influence expressed thoughts in the absence of overt semantic content. *Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics*, 82(8), 3945-3956.

[8] Meidenbauer, K.L., Stenfors, C.U.D., Bratman, G.N., Gross, J.J., **Schertz, K.E.**, Choe, K.W., & Berman, M.G. (2020). The affective benefits of nature exposure: What's nature got to do with it? *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 72, 101498.

[7] Layden, E.A., Li, H., **Schertz, K.E.**, Berman, M.G., & London, S.E. (2020). Experience selectively alters functional connectivity within a neural network to predict learned behavior in juvenile songbirds. *NeuroImage*, 222, 117218.

[6] **Schertz, K.E.** & Berman, M.G. (2019). Understanding nature and its cognitive benefits. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*, 28(5), 496-502.

[5] Stenfors, C.U.D., Van Hedger, S.C., **Schertz, K.E.**, Meyer, F.A., Smith, K.E.L., Norman, G.J., ... & Berman, M.G. (2019). Positive effects of nature on cognitive performance across multiple experiments: Test order but not affect modulates the cognitive effects. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 10, 438004.

[4] Meidenbauer, K.L., Stenfors, C.U.D., Young, J., Layden, E.A., **Schertz, K.E.**, Kardan, O., Decety, J., Berman, M.G. (2019). The gradual development of the preference for natural environments. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 65, 101328.

[3] Layden, E.A., **Schertz, K.E.**, London, S.E., & Berman, M.G. (2019). Interhemispheric functional connectivity in the zebra finch brain, absent the corpus callosum in normal ontogeny. *NeuroImage*, 195, 113-127.

[2] Van Hedger, K., Keedy, S.K., **Schertz, K.E.**, Berman, M.G., & de Wit, H. (2019). Effects of methamphetamine on neural responses to visual stimuli. *Psychopharmacology*, 236(6), 1741-1748.

[1] **Schertz, K.E.**, Sachdeva, S., Kardan, O., Kotabe, H.P., Wolf, K.L., & Berman, M.G. (2018). A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. *Cognition*, 174, 82-93.

Manuscripts in Submission

[3] **Schertz, K.E.***, Orvell, A.*, Chandhok, S., Vickers, B.D., Moser, J.S., Ayduk, O., & Kross E. Self-talk in everyday life: Frequency, form, and function. (Revise & resubmit, *Scientific Reports*)

[2] **Schertz, K.E.**, Sachdeva, S., Kross, E., & Berman, M.G. Let's talk about nature: Understanding multifaceted nature experiences in the United States using social media. (Revise & resubmit, *Environment & Behavior*)

[1] Meidenbauer, K.L., Pourkhalili, S., **Schertz, K.E.**, Janey, E.A., Berman, M.G. Sensitive to what? Environmental sensitivity primarily amplifies affective responses to the social (but not physical) environment. (Under review, *Journal of Personality & Social Psychology*)

Manuscripts in Preparation

[2] Orvell, A., **Schertz, K.E.**, Baldwin, C.R., Derosiers, K., Duckworth, A.L., Jonides, J., Katz, B., Willingham, D., & Kross, E. Teaching self-control promotes positive shifts in high school students' self-control knowledge, self-control behavior, and academic achievement.

[1] **Schertz, K.E.** & Kross, E. Nature experiences resolve acute rumination through perspective broadening.

Conference Proceedings

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2019). Visual features influence expressed thoughts in the absence of overt semantic content. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 24(p. 124). Madison, WI: Psychonomic Society.

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2018). ReTUNE: Restoring Through Urban Nature Experience. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 23(p. 284). Madison, WI: Psychonomic Society.

Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kardan, O., Kotabe, H.P., Wolf, K.L., & Berman, M.G. (2017). A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 22(p. 101). Madison, WI: Psychonomic Society.

Chrysikou, E.G., **Schertz, K.**, & Thompson-Schill, S.L. (2007). Influencing the lingering garden path effect through tasks of executive control. [Abstract]. *Abstracts of the Psychonomic Society*, 12 (p. 129). Austin, TX: Psychonomic Society.

INVITED TALKS

The psychological experience of nature (2024, May). Phipps Conservatory and Botanical Garden Biophilia Speaker Series, Pittsburgh, PA.

Social impacts of visits to natural spaces (2023, April). Wayne State University, Social Area Workshop, Detroit, MI.

The Benefits of Urban Greenspace for Cognition and Behavior. (2022, April). College of Lake County Sustainability Council Earth Week, Chicago, IL.

The Benefits of Urban Greenspace for Cognition and Behavior. (2019, April). University of Chicago-Tel Aviv University Workshop on Cities and Urbanism, Tel Aviv, Israel.

A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. (2017, August). University of Chicago Wisdom Research Forum, Chicago, IL.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Schertz, K.E. & Jolink, T.A. (Co-chairs) (2025, October). From “meet cutes” to tough times: Experimentally testing signals of connection in close relationships. Symposium to be conducted at the Society for Experimental Social Psychology Annual Conference, Lisbon, PT.

Schertz, K.E., Diamond, E., Rodriguez, M., Gordon, M.G., & Kross, E. (2025, October). Talking it out in nature: How physical environments shape conflict conversations in romantic relationships. Symposium talk to be presented at the Society for Experimental Social Psychology Annual Conference, Lisbon, PT.

Schertz, K.E. & Kross, E. (2025, February). The use of natural environments for emotion regulation in everyday life. Poster presented at the Emotion pre-conference of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Conference, Denver, CO.

Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kross, E., & Berman, M.G. (2023, October). Examining multifaceted nature experiences using social media data. Talk presented at the Association for Psychological Science DIV 34 Annual Conference, Online.

Schertz, K.E. & Kross, E. (2023, June). A tale of two paths to low effort emotion regulation. Talk presented at the International Organization of Psychophysiology, Geneva, CH.

Schertz, K.E. & Berman, M.G. (2022, June). Environmental influences on affect and cognition: A study of natural and commercial semi-public spaces. Talk presented at the Association for Psychological Science DIV 34 Annual Conference, Online.

Schertz, K.E., Bowman, J.E., Kotabe, H.P., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Lakhtakia, T., Lyu, M., Paraschos, O., Van Hedger, S.C., Vohs, K.D., Berman, M.G. (2022, May). Natural public spaces increase social and environmental thought content. Poster presented at the Association for Psychological Science Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.

Schertz, K.E., Bowman, J.E., Kotabe, H.P., Layden, E.A., Zhen, J., Lakhtakia, T., Lyu, M., Paraschos, O., Van Hedger, S.C., Vohs, K.D., Berman, M.G. (2022, February). Socially and environmentally focused thoughts are influenced by the surrounding physical environment. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA.

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2019, November). Visual features influence expressed thoughts in the absence of overt semantic content. Poster presented at the 60th Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, Montreal, QC.

Schertz, K.E., Cardenas-Iniguez, C., Saxon, J., & Berman, M.G. (2019, May). Environmental and social engagement contribute uniquely to predicting crime. Poster presented at the 31st Annual Convention of the Association for Psychological Science, Washington, D.C.

Schertz, K.E., Kardan, O., & Berman, M.G. (2018, November). ReTUNE: Restoring Through Urban Nature Experience. Poster presented at the 59th Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, New Orleans, LA.

Lyu, M., **Schertz, K.E.**, Choe, K.W., Chamberlain, B.C., Qin, X, Meitner, M.J., & Berman, M.G. (2018, May). Low-Level and semantic visual features predict preference in virtual environments. Poster presented at the 30th Annual Convention of the Association for Psychological Science, San Francisco, CA.

Schertz, K.E., Sachdeva, S., Kardan, O., Kotabe, H.P., Wolf, K.L., & Berman, M.G. (2017, November). A thought in the park: The influence of naturalness and low-level visual features on expressed thoughts. Poster presented at the 58th Annual Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, Vancouver, BC.

Schertz, K.E., Layden, E.A., London, S.E., & Berman, M.G. (2016, November). Functional connectivity and brain morphometry across development in zebra finches. Poster presented at the 46th Annual Meeting of the Society for Neuroscience, San Diego, CA.

Meyer, F., **Schertz, K.E.**, & Berman, M. G. (2016, May). Does interacting with nature in virtual reality restore directed attention? Poster presented at the 28th Annual Convention of the Association for Psychological Science, Chicago, IL.

CAMPUS/DEPARTMENTAL TALKS

Research and Practice Panel (2024, November). Nature for Wellness Symposium, University of Michigan.

The power of place: Environmental impacts on social and cognitive outcomes (2024, October). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

The psychological experience of nature: A Multi-Level, Multi-Method Analysis. (2023, October). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

This is your mind on nature. (2022, September). Social Psychology Brown Bag, University of Michigan.

Environmental influences on thought content and connectedness. (2020, November). Cognition Workshop, University of Chicago.

Environmental and Social Engagement Contribute Uniquely to Predicting Crime. (2019, March). Cognition Workshop, University of Chicago.

ReTUNE: Restoring Through Urban Nature Experience. (2018, March). Cognition Workshop, University of Chicago.

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Behavioral Science & Public Policy (grad) – Teaching Assistant	Spring 2021
Big Data in the Psychological Sciences – Teaching Assistant	Winter 2021
Experimental Design I/II (grad) – Teaching Assistant	Spring & Fall 2020
Psychology and Neurobiology of Stress – Teaching Assistant	Fall 2019

Mentor for Thesis Students

Evan Renn (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UMichigan)	2025
Sofia Micale (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UMichigan)	2024
Ethan Driscoll (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UMichigan)	2023
Senling Shu (Master's thesis, UChicago)	2022
Jillian Bowman (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UChicago)	2020
Tanvi Lakhtakia (Undergraduate, Honors thesis, UChicago)	2020

SERVICE

University of Chicago Psychology Graduate Student Organization

2021-2022	Grad Cross Talks Workshop, Organizer
2018-2019 / 2020-2021	Mentorship Program Coordinator
2018-2021	Travel & Research Committee Head
2017-2022	Travel & Research Committee Member

Undergraduate Research Symposia

2018	Chicago Area Symposium (Judge for posters)
2023, 2024	UMichigan Symposium (Judge for posters)
2024	UMichigan UROP Symposium (Judge for posters)

SKILLS

Languages: Expert in R. Familiar with SAS, Matlab, Python.

Data: Behavioral studies with adults (experimental and non-experimental); Neuroimaging (EEG), Qualtrics-based online surveys; U.S. Census data; cell phone mobility data, land cover data, Experience Sampling Methods, Physiological (ECG) signals

Analytics: Regression (e.g., Hierarchical/multilevel modeling, CCA), Frequentist and Bayesian approaches, Spatial/GIS Analysis, natural language processing (e.g., topic modeling)

PEER REVIEW ACTIVITIES

Ad-hoc reviewer for *PNAS*, *Science Advances*, *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, *Environment & Behavior*, *Scientific Reports*, *Experimental Psychology*, *Parks Stewardship Forum*, *Psychological Reports*, *Ecopsychology*, *Frontiers in Psychology*, *International Journal of Wellbeing*, *Journal of Cognitive Psychology*, *Journal of Affective Disorders*

ORGANIZATIONS

Society for Personality & Social Psychology

Association for Psychological Science

Society for Environmental, Population, & Conservation Psychology (APA Div 34)

REFERENCES

Ethan Kross, PhD
Professor of Psychology, University of Michigan
Professor of Management & Organizations, Ross School of Business
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Jason Moser, PhD
Professor of Psychology, Michigan State University
Email: jmoser@msu.edu

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